

Integrated Sensing, Computation, and Communication for UAV-Assisted Federated Edge Learning

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Abstract—Federated edge learning (FEEL) enables privacy-preserving model training through periodic communication between edge devices and the server. Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV)-mounted edge devices are particularly advantageous for FEEL due to their flexibility and mobility in efficient data collection. In UAV-assisted FEEL, sensing, computation, and communication are coupled and compete for limited onboard resources, and UAV deployment also affects sensing and communication performance. Therefore, the joint design of UAV deployment and resource allocation is crucial to achieving the optimal training performance. In this paper, we address the

problem of joint UAV deployment design and resource allocation for FEEL via a concrete case study of human motion recognition based on wireless sensing. We first analyze the impact of UAV deployment on the sensing quality and identify a threshold value for the sensing elevation angle that guarantees a satisfactory quality of data samples. Due to the non-ideal sensing channels, we consider the probabilistic sensing model, where the successful sensing probability of each UAV is determined by its position. Then, we derive the upper bound of the FEEL training loss as a function of the sensing probability. Theoretical results suggest that the convergence rate can be improved if UAVs have a uniform successful sensing probability. Based on this analysis, we formulate a training time minimization problem by jointly optimizing UAV deployment, integrated sensing, computation, and communication (ISCC) resources under a desirable optimality gap constraint. To solve this challenging mixed-integer non-convex problem, we apply the alternating optimization technique, and propose the bandwidth, batch size, and position optimization (BBPO) scheme to optimize these three decision variables alternately. Simulation results demonstrate that our BBPO scheme outperforms other baseline schemes regarding convergence rate and testing accuracy. The simulation implementation is available at <https://github.com/TheaSherlock/ISCC-UAV>.

Index Terms—Federated edge learning, UAV deployment design, sensing-computation-communication resource allocation, integrated sensing and communication.

I. INTRODUCTION

A. Motivations

ADVANCES in artificial intelligence (AI) and the Internet of Things (IoT) have shifted wireless networks from 5G's connected things to 6G's connected intelligence, with more stringent requirements for reliability and latency [1], [2], [3]. In the pursuit of demanding requirements, federated edge learning (FEEL) has emerged as a popular distributed framework that trains global machine learning (ML) models at the edge of wireless networks [4], [5], [6], which helps preserve data privacy and avoid long delays caused by data transmission. Owing to the UAVs' mobility, UAV-mounted edge devices can facilitate data collection in FEEL. A typical UAV-assisted FEEL iteration includes *sensing*, *computation*, and *communication*, particularly for FEEL [7]. Specifically, starting with a common initial model broadcast from the edge server, the UAV-mounted edge devices collect/sense data from the target and use their local sensing data to *compute* the

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model updates. Then, they *upload* their model updates to the edge server for further aggregation to yield an updated global model.

To fully exploit the benefits of UAV-assisted FEEL, overcoming several challenges associated with UAV deployment and limited onboard resources is crucial. *Firstly, UAV deployment affects the sensing data quality.* Due to practical constraints in sensing range and accuracy, the sensing data quality heavily relies on the sensing channel between the UAV and the target, which is controlled by the UAV position. This in turn affects the accuracy of model [8]. *Secondly, UAV deployment affects the communication efficiency.* The transmission rate of local model upload depends on the communication channel between the UAV and the server. As the channel model described in [9], shorter relative distances and larger elevation angles favour line-of-sight (LOS) communication links. However, this improved communication efficiency leads to a decrease in sensing quality. Specifically, the shorter the UAV-server distance, the longer the UAV-target distance, resulting in a complex sensing environment, such as dense obstacles, which hinder the ability of UAVs to sense the target successfully. As a result, the UAV deployment results in a tradeoff between sensing quality and communication efficiency, ultimately impacting the FEEL performance. *Thirdly, the limited onboard energy of UAVs imposes strict constraints on the duration of training.* In order to minimize the training time, it is essential to allocate resources efficiently on both the UAV and server sides. Therefore, we focus on the UAV deployment design and resource allocation in UAV-assisted FEEL to minimize the training time.

The preliminary studies [10], [11], [12], [13], [14] have mainly focused on implementing classical federated learning (FL) architectures using UAVs. Typically, UAVs are deployed as FL clients with stored datasets, or aerial base stations as model aggregators. In recent research [15], [16], [17], [18], [19], UAV deployment has been integrated into the FL system, enabling UAVs to serve as relays for efficient data collection from other devices, or as aggregators with an adaptive position to enhance the FL performance. However, *these existing studies rarely account for the data sensing process*, and assumed that the training data is either already available on the UAVs or can be directly acquired from other devices. In addition, *the sensing, computing, and communication processes are highly coupled in FEEL, competing for resources.* While the most relevant study [7] investigated the resource management of integrated sensing, computation, and communication (ISCC), it did not include UAV deployment in their problem formulation. Additionally, there is a notable absence of analysis regarding the influence of UAV deployment on sensing and communication performance. Therefore, we aim to address an open problem of *optimizing the UAV deployment and ISCC resource allocation to enhance the training performance in UAV-assisted FEEL systems.*

B. Contributions

In this paper, we propose a novel approach for human motion recognition using a UAV-assisted FEEL system. The system comprises multiple UAVs and one edge server. Each

UAV is considered an integrated sensing and communication (ISAC) device due to the size, weight, and power constraints [20], [21]. In each training round, the ISAC UAVs sense the target and get their local datasets through wireless sensing. However, due to complex sensing environments such as trees, buildings, and other obstacles, UAVs may fail to sense targets successfully. Therefore, we employ a probabilistic sensing model, where the relative positions of UAVs and targets determine the successful sensing probability. Only the UAVs that successfully sense the target can update their local models and upload them to the server for model aggregation. To minimize the total training time, we optimize the UAV deployment and ISCC resource allocation, including bandwidth and batch size design, building upon a partial participation FEEL framework. We aim to address three main challenges: 1) How does UAV deployment affect the sensing quality? 2) How does the probabilistic sensing model affects FEEL convergence? 3) How can we optimize the UAV deployment and ISCC resource allocation to improve the training performance?

We summarize the key results and contributions as follows:

- **Impact of UAV deployment on sensing quality:** We provide a theoretical analysis of the sensing process and verify it experimentally. Our results demonstrate that the sensing quality will reach a *very good level* when the sensing elevation angle is larger than a given threshold. This finding suggests that it is sufficient to sense targets at the aforementioned elevation angle threshold so that each UAV can generate high-quality data samples. This addresses the first challenge above.
- **FEEL convergence analysis under probabilistic sensing model:** We first analyze the effect of the successful sensing probability on the convergence of FEEL by deriving the upper bound of the training loss. Our derived theoretical results show that non-uniform successful sensing probabilities amplify the negative effects caused by data heterogeneity. However, these negative effects can be mitigated if UAVs have uniform successful sensing probabilities. This addresses the second challenge above.
- **Optimized UAV deployment and ISCC resource allocation:** Based on solutions to the two challenges above, we formulate a joint UAV deployment and ISCC resource allocation problem to minimize the total training time under per round latency and training optimality gap constraints. To solve this challenging mixed-integer non-convex problem, we adopt the alternating optimization technique and split it into three subproblems, which optimize the bandwidth, batch size, and UAV position, respectively. Our scheme can efficiently compute suboptimal solutions. This addresses the third challenge above.
- **Performance evaluation:** We perform extensive simulations of a specific wireless sensing task (i.e., human motion recognition) on a high-fidelity wireless sensing simulator [22]. Our bandwidth, batch size, and position optimization (BBPO) scheme achieves the best convergence rate and testing accuracy performance compared to other baseline schemes.

The rest of this paper is organized as follows. Section II discusses the related works. Section III describes the system model. Section IV presents the theoretical analysis of the sensing process. Section V establishes the problem formulation. Section VI develops the UAV deployment design and ISCC resource management. Section VII provides the simulation results, and Section VIII concludes this paper.

II. RELATED WORKS

Initial studies on UAV-assisted FEEL focused primarily on implementing classical FL architectures using UAVs [10], [11], [12], [13], [14]. Typically, the UAVs are deployed as FL clients with stored datasets or aerial base stations as model aggregators. To fully reap the benefits of the UAV's mobility, recent works [15], [16], [17], [18], [19] have integrated UAV deployment into the UAV-assisted FEEL system, enabling UAVs to efficiently collect data from other devices, or act as an aggregator with adaptive position to enhance FL performance. For example, Ng et al. [15] proposed using UAVs as wireless relays to facilitate communications between the Internet of Vehicles (IoV) components and the FL aggregator, thus improving the accuracy of the FL. Similarly, Lim et al. [16] proposed an FL-based sensing and collaborative learning approach for UAV-enabled IoVs, where UAVs collect data from subregions and train ML models for IoVs. In [17], the authors proposed an asynchronous advantage actor-critic-based joint device selection, UAV placement, and resource management algorithm to enhance federated convergence rate and accuracy. Additionally, the work in [18] introduced a new online FL scheme to improve the performance of personalized local models by jointly optimizing the CPU frequency and trajectories of the UAVs. The work in [19] proposed a joint algorithm for UAV placement, power control, bandwidth allocation, and computing resources, to minimize the energy consumption of the UAV aggregator and users.

Overall, these studies [10], [11], [12], [13], [14], [15], [16], [17], [18], [19] assumed that training data is readily available onboard the UAVs or can be obtained from other devices, regardless of the data sensing process. However, this assumption can significantly impact training performance since sensing, computation, and communication in UAV-assisted FEEL are *interdependent* and compete for resources. The most related study [7] focused on integrated sensing, computation, and communication (ISCC) resource management to optimize training performance. However, they did not consider the UAV-mounted edge devices, which could significantly affect sensing and communication performance. Therefore, we aim to address an open problem of optimizing ISCC resource allocation and UAV deployment to enhance the training performance in a UAV-assisted FEEL system.

III. SYSTEM MODEL

As shown in Fig. 1, we consider a UAV-assisted FEEL system consisting of K UAVs and a server. The set of UAVs is represented as $\mathcal{K} = \{1, 2, \dots, K\}$. Each UAV is equipped with a single-antenna ISAC transceiver that can switch between the sensing and communication modes as

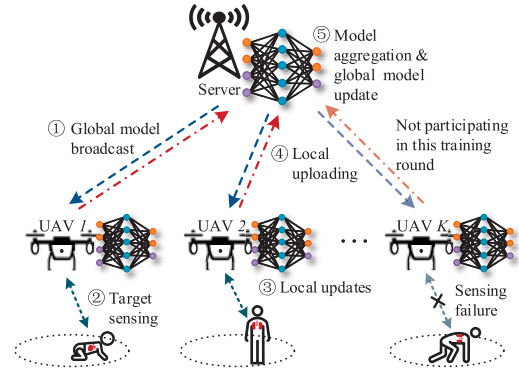


Fig. 1. UAV-assisted FEEL system with integrated sensing, communication, and computation.

needed in a time-division manner.¹ Specifically, in the sensing mode, a dedicated radar waveform frequency-modulated continuous-wave (FMCW) [21] is transmitted. Then, sensing data containing the motion information of the human target can be obtained on board the UAVs by processing the received radar echo signals. This mode is used for UAVs to collect training data. On the other hand, in the communication mode, a constant frequency carrier modulated by communication data is transmitted. This mode is used for information exchange between UAVs and the edge server. Our UAV-assisted FEEL system aims to train an ML model for specific aerial sensing applications, e.g., target recognition, using the data wirelessly sensed by the UAVs.

A. Learning Model

The training process is to minimize a global loss function in a distributed manner. In particular, we define the global loss function as

$$F(\mathbf{w}) = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \mathbb{E}_{\varepsilon \sim \mathcal{P}_k} [f_k(\mathbf{w}; \varepsilon)], \quad (1)$$

where $\mathbf{w}$ represents the global model, jointly trained on all UAVs and coordinated with the edge server. The function $f_k(\mathbf{w}; \varepsilon)$ is the local loss function for UAV k , and ε is a random seed with distribution $\mathcal{P}_k$, of which its realization represents a batch of samples. To facilitate the subsequent analysis, we define $F_k(\mathbf{w}) = \mathbb{E}_{\varepsilon \sim \mathcal{P}_k} [f_k(\mathbf{w}; \varepsilon)]$. The training process is iterated in multiple communication rounds. The system repeats the following five steps in each round n until the global model converges (see Fig. 1).

- 1) **Global model broadcasting:** The server broadcasts the current global model $\mathbf{w}^{(n)}$ to each UAV via the wireless broadcast channel.
- 2) **Target sensing:** Each UAV switches to the sensing mode and transmits dedicated FMCW signals for target sensing. We assume that the UAV can only sense the target successfully if it has a LOS sensing link with the target and no obstacles in the link. This is because, in a NLOS sensing link, fewer reflected signals can reach the UAV with a specific airborne altitude, and the majority of these signals are attenuated by the

¹A practical implementation of such an ISAC device via a software-defined radio platform has been demonstrated in [20].

ground environment. Due to the unpredictable sensing environment, we utilize the LOS probabilistic model² for sensing. We define the 3-dimensional coordinates of UAV k as $\mathbf{u}_k = (x_{u,k}, y_{u,k}, z_{u,k})$, where $z_{u,k}$ represents the flying altitude. The 3-dimensional coordinates of the sensed target is $\mathbf{v}_k = (x_{v,k}, y_{v,k}, z_{v,k})$, where $z_{v,k}$ is the altitude of the corresponding target. The successful sensing probability of UAV k is [9]

$$q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{1}{1 + \psi \exp(-\zeta[\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \psi])}, \quad (2)$$

where ψ and ζ are constant values determined by the type of environment, $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ is the sensing elevation angle between UAV k at position $\mathbf{u}_k$ and its sensed target. More specifically, $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{180^\circ}{\pi} \times \sin^{-1} \left| \frac{z_{u,k} - z_{v,k}}{d_{s,k}} \right|$, where $d_{s,k} = \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\|$ is the Euclidean distance between UAV k and the sensed target. Once UAV k successfully senses the target in round n , it obtains a batch of data samples with size δ_k , which can vary adaptively across different UAVs but remain unchanged across all training rounds.

- 3) **Local gradient updating:** Each UAV that successfully senses the target updates its local gradient by running one step of the stochastic gradient descent (SGD) from $\mathbf{w}^{(n)}$,³ i.e.,

$$\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)} = \frac{1}{\delta_k} \sum_{\iota \in \mathcal{D}_k^{(n)}} \nabla f_k(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}; \iota), \quad (3)$$

where $\mathcal{D}_k^{(n)}$ represents the sensing samples with size $|\mathcal{D}_k^{(n)}| = \delta_k$. For UAVs that do not successfully sense the targets, their local gradients will not be updated, i.e., $\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)} = \mathbf{g}_k^{(n-1)}$.

- 4) **Local uploading:** We assume that only successfully sensed UAVs upload their local gradients to the server via the uplink wireless channel (see Section IV for more details). Thus, we consider the partial participating FEEL scenario.
- 5) **Global model aggregation and updating:** The server aggregates local gradients and updates global model as

$$\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)} = \mathbf{w}^{(n)} - \eta \frac{\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) \mathbf{g}_k^{(n)}}{\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)}, \quad (4)$$

where η is the learning rate. The indicator function $\mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ represents whether UAV k successfully senses the target in round n , that is

$$\mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{sense successfully w.p. } q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k), \\ 0, & \text{otherwise w.p. } 1 - q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k). \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

This aggregation method (4) streamlines the convergence analysis, yielding more elegant results for extracting insights.

²The formulation and the analysis can be readily applied to other probabilistic sensing models described in [23] and [24].

³We opt for federated stochastic gradient descent in local computation, given its advantages in terms of robustness to non-i.i.d. data distribution [25].

B. UAV-Server Communication Model

Without loss of generality, we define the 3-dimensional coordinates of the server as $\mathbf{s} = (x_s, y_s, z_s)$, where z_s is the altitude of the server. Next, we analyze the channel model between UAV k and the server, which can be LOS or non-LOS (NLOS). The LOS probability in each round n is [9]

$$q_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{1}{1 + \psi \exp(-\zeta[\theta_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \psi])}, \quad (6)$$

where $\theta_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ is the communication elevation angle. More specifically, $\theta_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{180^\circ}{\pi} \times \sin^{-1} \left| \frac{z_{u,k} - z_s}{d_{c,k}} \right|$, where $d_{c,k} = \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{s}\|$ is the Euclidean distance between UAV k and the server. For ease of analysis, we consider that the UAVs are flying at a constant altitude, i.e., $z_{u,k} = H$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. Moreover, the NLOS probability is $1 - q_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$. The average channel gain between UAV k and the server is [3], [26]

$$h_k(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{(K_0 d_{c,k})^{-\alpha}}{\eta_1 q_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) + \eta_2 (1 - q_{c,k}(\mathbf{u}_k))}, \quad (7)$$

where $K_0 = \frac{4\pi f_c}{c}$, f_c is the carrier frequency, c is the speed of light, and α is the path loss exponent of the link between the UAV and the server. Also, η_1 and η_2 ($\eta_2 > \eta_1 > 1$) are the excessive path loss coefficients in LOS and NLOS cases,⁴ respectively, which models the shadowing effect and reflection effect [9].

We consider that each UAV is assigned a dedicated sub-channel of bandwidth B_k for uploading. The UAVs are intended to operate within the same cellular cell, where frequency reuse will not be implemented. Suppose that UAV k uploads the gradient with a power of $p_{c,k} > 0$. The received rate of the server from UAV k is

$$r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k) = B_k \log \left(1 + \frac{p_{c,k} h_k(\mathbf{u}_k)}{B_k N_0} \right), \quad (8)$$

where the bandwidth allocation is limited by the total bandwidth B_c such that $\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} B_k = B_c$, and N_0 is the noise power spectral density. Additionally, in order to prevent UAV collisions, we enforce the constraint $\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{u}_{k'}\|^2 \geq d_{min}^2$, $\forall k, k' \in \mathcal{K}$, where d_{min} represents the minimum safe distance between UAVs.

C. UAV-Target Sensing Model

The dedicated FMCW signal consisting of multiple up-chirps is used for UAVs' sensing [21]. The sensing signal of UAV k at time t is defined as $x_k(t)$. We use the primitive-based method [27] to model the scattering from the whole human body to UAVs. The human contains L body primitives. The scattering along a direct/indirect reflection path is approximated using the superposition of the returns from L body primitives. The signal received by UAV k at time t is

$$y_k(t) = \sqrt{p_{s,k}(t)} \times \frac{A_0}{\sqrt{4\pi}} \sum_{l=1}^L y_{k,l}(t) + n_k(t), \quad (9)$$

where $p_{s,k}(t)$ is the sensing power of UAV k , $y_{k,l} = \sqrt{G_{k,l}(t)/d_{k,l}^2(t)} \exp(-j \frac{4\pi f_c}{c} d_{k,l}(t)) x_{k,l}(t - 2 \frac{d_{k,l}(t)}{c})$, A_0 is

⁴Our model can be simplified to a LOS model by adjusting η_1, η_2 .

the gain of the antenna, $G_{k,l}(t)$ is the complex amplitude proportional to the radar cross section of the l -th primitive, $d_{k,l}(t)$ is the distance from the l -th primitive to UAV k , and $n_k(t)$ is the signal due to ground clutter and noise. Note that we only consider the direct reflection path in (9), since UAVs in aerial space are less susceptible to indirect reflection paths.

D. Training Time

Based on the learning procedure in Section III-A, the latency for each UAV k in training round n consists of the following four parts:

- *Broadcasting time:* The server transmits the current global model to UAVs using power p_b and the entire frequency band B_c . We consider the data size of the gradient to be a constant, defined as D_0 . The model broadcasting time from the server to UAV k is

$$T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) = \frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)}, \quad (10)$$

where $r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c) = B_c \log \left(1 + \frac{p_b h_k(\mathbf{u}_k)}{B_c N_0} \right)$, and $h_k(\mathbf{u}_k)$ is the average channel gain between UAV k and the server, as defined in (7). Since each UAV k is located at a different position $\mathbf{u}_k$, the broadcasting time from the server to each UAV can vary.

- *Sensing time:* We consider that each UAV takes time T_0 to generate a sample (see Section IV for details). The number of samples generated by UAV k is δ_k . Thus, the sensing time of UAV k in round n is

$$T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k) = T_0 \cdot \delta_k. \quad (11)$$

- *Local computation time:* The indicator function $\mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ defined in (5) indicates whether UAV k successfully senses the target. Since UAVs partly participate in FEEL, the local calculation time of UAV k in round n is

$$T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k) = \mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) \cdot \frac{\delta_k \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}}, \quad (12)$$

where ξ is the CPU cycles required to execute one sample in the local gradient computing, and f_{cpu} is each UAV's CPU frequency (cycles/s).

- *Local upload time:* Each UAV that successfully senses the target needs to upload its gradient to the server. We consider the data size of the gradient to be a constant, defined as D_0 . The local upload time of UAV k in round n is

$$T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k) = \mathbf{1}_k^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) \cdot \frac{D_0}{r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)}. \quad (13)$$

We consider the synchronous FL on the server side, i.e., aggregation happens until local gradients from all participating UAVs are received. Then, the latency for round n is⁵

$$\begin{aligned} T^{(n)}(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, \{B_k\}) \\ = \max_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \{T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) + T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k) + T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k) + T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)\}. \end{aligned} \quad (14)$$

⁵For ease of illustration, we denote $\{\delta_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$, and $\{B_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$ as $\{\delta_k\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and $\{B_k\}$, respectively.

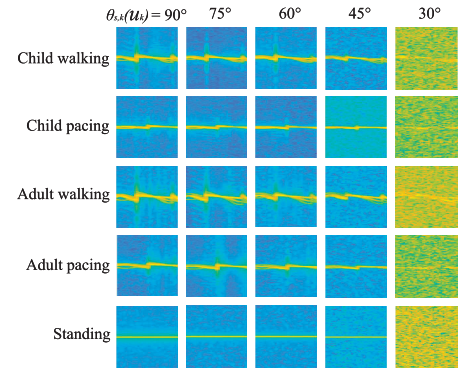


Fig. 2. The spectrograms of five human motions at different sensing elevation angles $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$.

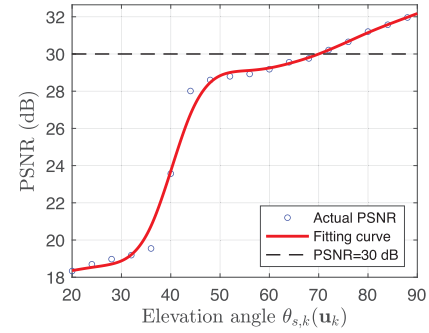


Fig. 3. The quality of spectrogram PSNR versus sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$.

IV. SENSING ANALYSIS

In this section, we analyze the effect of UAV deployment on the quality of sensing samples. Micro-Doppler signature is a characteristic of human motion.

We aim to verify our hypothesis that there exists a threshold value of the sensing evaluation angle that can guarantee a satisfactory quality of the data samples. A common technique for micro-Doppler analysis is time-frequency representation, such as spectrograms [21]. Therefore, the received signal in (9) requires further preprocessing to obtain the micro-Doppler signature. Specifically, each spectrogram is generated from the received signal over a time period $T_0 = MT_p$, where M is the number of chirps and T_p is the duration of each chirp. Since each UAV k can control δ_k collected samples (i.e. spectrograms), as defined in Section III-A, UAV k needs to sense the target for a continuous duration of $\delta_k T_0$. The received raw signal in (9) first needs to be sampled with rate f_s . After that, the signal in the ρ -th sensing duration can be reconstructed as a 2D sensing data matrix $\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho) \in \mathbb{C}^{f_s T_p \times M}$ [7], i.e.,

$$\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho) = \sqrt{p_{s,k}(\rho)} \times \frac{A_0}{\sqrt{4\pi}} \sum_{l=1}^L \mathbf{Y}_{k,l}(\rho) + \mathbf{N}_k(\rho), \quad (15)$$

where $\mathbf{Y}_{k,l}(\rho) = \sqrt{G_{k,l}(\rho)} / d_{k,l}^2(\rho) \exp(-j \frac{4\pi f_c}{c} d_{k,l}(\rho)) \mathbf{X}_{k,l}(\rho)$. Sensing power $p_{s,k}(\rho)$ and distance $d_{k,l}(\rho)$ will remain constant for each ρ -th duration, where $\rho \in [1, 2, \dots, \delta_k]$. The element of row r and column m of matrix $\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho)$ is $[\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho)]_{r,m} = y_k((\rho-1)T_0 + (m-1)T_p + \frac{r}{f_s})$, $[\mathbf{X}_{k,l}(\rho)]_{r,m} = x_{k,l}((\rho-1)T_0 + (m-1)T_p + \frac{r}{f_s} - 2 \frac{d_{k,l}(\rho)}{c})$, and $[\mathbf{N}_k(\rho)]_{r,m} =$

$n_k((\rho-1)T_0 + (m-1)T_p + \frac{r}{f_s})$, where $r \in [1, 2, \dots, f_s T_p]$ represents the sampled signal index, and $m \in [1, 2, \dots, M]$ represents the chirp index.

Next, we adapt the short-time Fourier transform (STFT) with a sliding window function $o[w]$ of length W to generate the range-Doppler-time (RDT) cube in order to obtain time-frequency features of $\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho)$. The RDT cube of $\mathbf{Y}_k(\rho)$ after STFT is given by [7] and [21]

$$\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}_k(\rho, f) = \sqrt{p_{s,k}(\rho)} \times \frac{A_0}{\sqrt{4\pi}} \sum_{l=1}^L \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}_{k,l}(\rho, f) + \tilde{\mathbf{N}}_k(\rho, f), \quad (16)$$

where $\tilde{\mathbf{Y}}_{k,l}(\rho, f) = \sqrt{G_{k,l}(\rho)} / d_{k,l}^2(\rho) \exp(-j \frac{4\pi f c}{c} d_{k,l}(\rho)) \tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)$. The element of $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)$ is

$$[\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)]_{r,m} = \sum_{w=0}^W x'_{k,l} \exp(-j \frac{2\pi f w}{W}) o(w), \quad (17)$$

where $x'_{k,l} = x_{k,l}((\rho-1)T_0 + (m(W-Q) - w - 1)T_p + \frac{r}{f_s} - 2 \frac{d_{k,l}(\rho)}{c})$, Q is the number of overlapping points, $f \in [0, W-1]$ and $m \in [1, \frac{M-Q}{W-Q}]$ are the frequency and temporal shift index, respectively. We non-coherently integrate $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)$ within all the range bins, and obtain the integrated STFT as $[\bar{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)]_m = \sum_{r=1}^{f_s T_p} [\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)]_{r,m}$. Moreover, the element definition of $\tilde{\mathbf{N}}_k(\rho, f)$ is similar to $\tilde{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)$. Then, we have (18), shown at the bottom of the next page, where the clutter and noise related term $\bar{\mathbf{N}}_k(\rho, f)$ represents the interference, and the rest represents useful information in the spectrogram.

Remark 1: Impact of UAV position $\{u_k\}$ on spectrogram quality. From (18), we can see that the quality of spectrograms improves as we reduce $d_{k,l}(\rho)$, which is the distance between UAV k and the l -th primitive of the human body. Since each UAV k flies at a constant altitude, distance $d_{k,l}(\rho)$ is minimized when the UAV hovers over the target, which leads to the best quality of the spectrograms. The experimental results also validate this in Fig. 2 and Fig. 3. For ease of illustration, we show the relationship between the spectrogram and sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(u_k) \in [0^\circ, 90^\circ]$. Note that higher $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$ leads to smaller $d_{k,l}(\rho)$. We apply the wireless sensing simulator in [22] to simulate various human motions and generate five human motion spectrograms as shown in Fig. 2. We can observe that when $\theta_{s,k}(u_k) = 30^\circ$, the quality of the spectrogram becomes the worst. Moreover, we use the peak-signal-to-noise ratio (PSNR) index⁶ to visualize the quality of the spectrogram [28]. Fig. 3 shows the average PSNR versus $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$, and a fitting curve that is very close to actual PSNR. Based on the human motion spectrograms, we calculate the average PSNR for the five human motions corresponding to each $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$, represented by blue circles in Fig. 3. To illustrate the changing trend of PSNR concerning $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$, a fitting curve is provided, depicted as the red curve

⁶PSNR is a metric measuring the perceptual difference between two similar images, widely used in image compression and computer vision. It is a complete reference metric that requires two images, i.e., a reference image and a processed image.

in Fig. 3. We can see that PSNR increases with $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$ and reaches the highest value at $\theta_{s,k}(u_k) = 90^\circ$.

Since the spectrograms have a *very good level* of quality when $\text{PSNR} \geq 30$ dB [29], we can set a threshold for the sensing evaluation angle, e.g. $\theta_{s,k}(u_k) \geq \theta_0$. As a result, each UAV can generate data samples (spectrograms) of roughly satisfactory quality. Please note that we employ two progressive steps to guarantee effective sensing performance: LOS ensures successful sensing, while PSNR ensures the quality of sensing.

V. PROBLEM FORMULATION

In this section, we aim to speed up the training process under a specific optimality gap of the loss function. In Sections V-A and V-B, we analyze the convergence of the UAV-assisted FEEL training process and derive an upper bound on the loss function. In Section V-C, we formulate the training time minimization problem through bandwidth allocation, batch size design, and UAV position design, which balances the sensing, computation, and communication during training. In Section V-D, we analyze the feasibility of the problem considering the UAV's limited onboard energy.

A. Assumptions

We consider general smooth convex learning problems with the following commonly adopted assumptions [30], [31], [32], [33].

Assumption 1 (Smoothness): Each local function $F_k(\mathbf{w})$ is Lipschitz continuous with Lipschitz constant L : $\forall \mathbf{w}_i$ and $\mathbf{w}_j$, $F_k(\mathbf{w}_i) \leq F_k(\mathbf{w}_j) + (\mathbf{w}_i - \mathbf{w}_j)^T \nabla F_k(\mathbf{w}_j) + \frac{L}{2} \|\mathbf{w}_i - \mathbf{w}_j\|^2$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$.

Assumption 2 (Strong convexity): Each local function $F_k(\mathbf{w})$ is strongly convex in that there exists a constant $\mu > 0$ such that $\forall \mathbf{w}_i$ and $\mathbf{w}_j$, $F_k(\mathbf{w}_i) \geq F_k(\mathbf{w}_j) + (\mathbf{w}_i - \mathbf{w}_j)^T \nabla F_k(\mathbf{w}_j) + \frac{\mu}{2} \|\mathbf{w}_i - \mathbf{w}_j\|^2$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$.

Assumption 3 (Unbiasedness and Bounded Variance of Local Gradients): The mean and variance of stochastic gradient $\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)}$ of local loss function $F_k(\mathbf{w})$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$, satisfy that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)}] &= \nabla F_k(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}), \\ \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)} - \nabla F_k(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2] &\leq \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k}, \end{aligned}$$

where δ_k is the batch size in calculating gradient $\mathbf{g}_k^{(n)}$.

Assumption 4 (Bounded data variance):

$$\mathbb{E}[\|\nabla F_k(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - \nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2] \leq \Lambda_k^2,$$

which measures the heterogeneity of local datasets.

B. Theoretical Results

Under Assumptions 1-4, the following theorem establishes the convergence rate.

Theorem 1: Consider the UAV-assisted FEEL system with a fixed learning rate η , satisfying

$$0 < \eta < \frac{1}{4L}. \quad (19)$$

The expected optimality gap of the loss function after n rounds is upper bounded by

$$\mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] \leq G \frac{1 - (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta))^n}{\mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta)} + (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta))^n \lambda, \quad (20)$$

with

$$G = \eta \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \alpha_k^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) + L\eta^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) + 2L\eta^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2, \quad (21)$$

where $\mathbf{w}_*$ is the optimal model as $\mathbf{w}_* = \arg \min_{\mathbf{w}} F(\mathbf{w})$, $\lambda = \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^0) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)]$, and each $\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ is a function of $\{q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k), \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$, as shown in equations (1), (5), and (10) in online appendix [34], and $\bar{q}_s = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ is the average successful sensing probability of UAVs. We represent the right hand side of (20) as $\Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, n)$, and we have $\mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] \leq \Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, n)$.

Proof: See Appendix. $\square$

It can be seen from (21) that when the UAVs have different successful sensing probabilities $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$, the negative effects caused by data heterogeneity $2L\eta^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2$ will be amplified. However, these negative effects can be mitigated if UAVs have uniform successful sensing probabilities $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = q_s, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. In this case, the training process can still converge to a proper stationary solution. Next, we derive the following corollary.

Corollary 1: Under learning rate constraint (19), when UAVs have the uniform successful sensing probability (i.e., $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = q_s, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$), we can obtain an upper bound of G in (21) as

$$G \leq \frac{\eta}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) + \frac{2L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi q_s} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) + \frac{4L\eta^2}{K q_s^{K-2}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \Lambda_k^2, \quad (22)$$

where $\chi = 1 - (1 - q_{s,\min})^K$, and $q_{s,\min} = \min_{\mathbf{u}_k} q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ with constraint $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) \geq \theta_0, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$.

The proof of Corollary 1 is given in [34].

Remark 2: From Theorem 1 and Corollary 1, we have two important insights: **1) From (20) and (22), it can be seen that the convergence rate is affected by the batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ and the successful sensing probability q_s . Specifically, we observe that a decrease in $\{\delta_k\}$ slows down the training convergence in (22), because fewer data samples are used for each training round. Moreover, a smaller q_s also deteriorates the training convergence in (22). Since only UAVs that successfully sense the targets can participate in the training, a smaller q_s**

represents the smaller successful sensing probability, and the smaller probability of the UAVs participating in the training. Therefore, the left hand side of (20) takes more training rounds to converge. 2) From (20), the loss function eventually converges as $n \rightarrow \infty$, and $\mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)]$ will reach $\frac{G}{\mu\eta(1-4L\mu)}$ instead of diminishing to zero. Given that G depends on successful sensing probability q_s and batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ in (22), reducing the values of these factors will lead to more severe biases. This is due to the use of fewer data samples and the reduced probability of UAVs participating in training. Therefore, partial UAV participation and smaller batch size can negatively impact the training process, resulting in the loss function converging to a biased solution.

C. Problem Formulation

As probabilistic sensing is inevitable in delay-constrained wireless sensing systems, our goal is to investigate its impact on the training time of UAV-assisted FEEL. From (2), we know that the successful sensing probability is determined by UAV position. Therefore, we formulate a resource allocation problem to minimize the total training time by optimizing the batch size $\{\delta_k\}$, UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and bandwidth $\{B_k\}$.

$$\mathbf{P1:} \min_{\substack{\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, \\ \{B_k\}, N, T_{\max}}} N \cdot T_{\max}$$

$$\text{s.t.} \quad \Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N) \leq \epsilon, \quad (23a)$$

$$\mathbb{E}[T^{(n)}(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, \{B_k\})] \leq T_{\max}, \forall n \in \mathcal{N}_\epsilon, \quad (23b)$$

$$q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = q_{s,k'}(\mathbf{u}_{k'}), \forall k, k' \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (23c)$$

$$\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) \geq \theta_0, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (23d)$$

$$\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{u}_{k'}\|^2 \geq d_{\min}^2, \forall k, k' \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (23e)$$

$$\delta_k \in \mathbb{Z}^+, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (23f)$$

$$\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} B_k = B_c, \quad (23g)$$

$$NT_{\max} \cdot P_{hov} \leq E_0. \quad (23h)$$

The objective function $N \cdot T_{\max}$ is the total training time, where N is the number of training rounds required to guarantee the ϵ -optimality gap, i.e., $\mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(N)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] \leq \Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N) \leq \epsilon$ in (23a), and $T_{\max}$ is the per round latency. Constraint in (23b) indicates that the average training time per round cannot exceed the delay requirement $T_{\max}$, and $\mathcal{N}_\epsilon = \{1, \dots, N\}$ is the set of training rounds. As suggested by Corollary 1, it is crucial to maintain a uniform successful sensing probability across the UAVs, so we enforce the constraints in (23c). To satisfy (23c), UAVs can operate in the same type of environment and have the same sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ with their respective targets. This is a sufficient condition to ensure uniform successful sensing probabilities. The constraint on sensing quality (23d) has been discussed in Section IV. The constraint stated in Equation (23e) ensures

$$\bar{\mathbf{Y}}_k(\rho, f) = \sqrt{p_{s,k}(\rho)} \times \underbrace{\frac{A_0}{\sqrt{4\pi}} \sum_{l=1}^L \frac{\sqrt{G_{k,l}(\rho)}}{d_{k,l}^2(\rho)} \exp\left(-j \frac{4\pi f_c}{c} d_{k,l}(\rho)\right) \bar{\mathbf{X}}_{k,l}(\rho, f)}_{\text{Useful information}} + \underbrace{\bar{\mathbf{N}}_k(\rho, f)}_{\text{Interference}}, \quad (18)$$

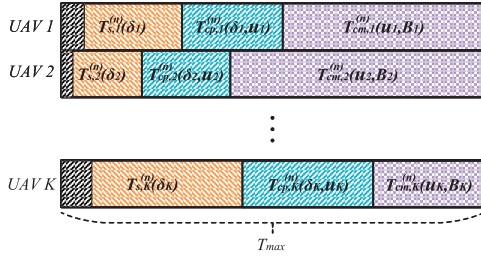


Fig. 4. An illustration of per round latency. Broadcasting time $T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)$, sensing time $T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k)$, computation time $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$, and communication time $T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ of each UAV k are indicated in black, orange, blue, and purple, respectively. The per round latency is $T_{\max} = \max_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \{T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) + T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k) + T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k) + T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)\}$ in (14).

the avoidance of collisions among UAVs. We consider that batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ are integer variables in (23f). Moreover, equation (23g) constrains the total bandwidth allocated to all UAVs as B_c . During the training process, the UAVs maintain a hovering state with a power consumption of P_{hov} . Constraint in 23h specifies the energy budget E_0 of each UAV.

The objective function and constraints (23a) and (23b) in **P1** are complicated by the coupling of $\{\delta_k\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and $\{B_k\}$. Furthermore, the batch size δ_k of each UAV k can only take integer values. Therefore, **P1** is a mixed-integer non-convex problem and is thus very challenging to solve optimally. We suppose that **P1** has feasible solutions. To deal with this difficulty, we utilize the alternating optimization technique to solve it with any given N , in which the three decision variables are optimized alternately. Moreover, we adopt a one-dimension search to find N to achieve the minimum objective value in an offline manner.

Next, we show how the decision variables $\{\delta_k\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ and $\{B_k\}$ affect the objective function $N \cdot T_{\max}$ as follows.

Remark 3: The batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ balances the number of training rounds N and the per round latency $T_{\max}$. For UAVs that successfully sense targets, a larger $\{\delta_k\}$ indicates longer sensing and local computation time, since they are proportional to $\{\delta_k\}$ defined in (11) and (12). Thus, the $T_{\max}$, including sensing, computation and communication time, will also increase. However, large batch sizes can speed up the convergence and reduce N . Therefore, the batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ must be properly designed to minimize the total training time.

Remark 4: The UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ also balances the number of training rounds N and the per round latency $T_{\max}$. Specifically, when UAV k is close to the target, the sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ will increase. Since the successful sensing probability $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ increases with $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$, the UAV also have a higher probability of participating in the training. This will accelerate the convergence of FEEL and reduce N . However, in this case, UAVs may be far away from the server, and the bandwidth allocated to each UAV will be reduced due to more UAVs participating in the training. These factors will slow the uplink transmission rate and increase $T_{\max}$. Therefore, the UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ also needs to be properly designed to minimize the total training time.

Remark 5: The Bandwidth $\{B_k\}$ can minimize the per round latency $T_{\max}$. Based on (11) and (12), we have that

sensing time $T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k)$ and local computation time $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$ increase with δ_k . Since each UAV can choose different δ_k the number of generated samples, $T_{s,k}^{(n)}$ and $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$ will exhibit diversity among different UAVs. We introduce bandwidth allocation in the system, let each UAV k control the uplink transmission time $T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ by adjusting B_k , to minimize $T_{\max}$. As shown in Fig. 4, UAV 2 spends less time downloading global models, sensing, and local computation, while UAV K spends more time on these aspects. That is, $T_{b,2}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_2) + T_{s,2}^{(n)}(\delta_2) + T_{cp,2}^{(n)}(\delta_2, \mathbf{u}_2) < T_{b,K}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_K) + T_{s,K}^{(n)}(\delta_K) + T_{cp,K}^{(n)}(\delta_K, \mathbf{u}_K)$. In this way, we can allocate less bandwidth to UAV 2 to achieve large $T_{cm,2}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_2, B_2)$ and allocate more bandwidth to UAV K to achieve small $T_{cm,K}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_K, B_K)$, so that the total latency of UAV 2 is equal to that of UAV K . Thus, adjusting $\{B_k\}$ can minimize $T_{\max}$.

D. Feasibility Analysis

We have a federated learning performance guarantee, which requires that the optimality gap of the loss function must be smaller than a specified threshold; this is represented by constraint (23a) in **P1**. Since the optimality gap $\Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N)$ is dependent on the number of training rounds N , it is essential that the UAVs have sufficient energy to support the required number of training rounds. Therefore, we analyze the feasibility of **P1** as follows.

Based on (25), we first derive the upper bound of the per round latency for UAV k as follows $\frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)} + T_0 \cdot \delta_k + q_s \cdot \frac{\delta_k \xi}{f_{cpu}} + q_s \cdot \frac{D_0}{r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)} \leq \frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\hat{\mathbf{u}}_k, B_c)} + T_0 \cdot \delta_{max} + \frac{\delta_{max} \xi}{f_{cpu}} + \frac{D_0}{r_k(\hat{\mathbf{u}}_k, B_{min})}$, where $\hat{\mathbf{u}}_k$ is the UAV position farthest from the server. We consider that each UAV is allocated the minimum bandwidth B_{min} and the minimum batch size δ_{min} . We define the right-hand side of the above equation as T_k^{upp} . Consequently, the upper bound of per round latency is $T^{upp} = \{T_k^{upp}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$. Due to the energy budget E_0 , we have the minimum training round $N_{min} = \frac{E_0}{T^{upp} \cdot P_{hov}}$. To satisfy the constraint (23a), we must ensure that there exists a feasible solution for $\Phi(\{\delta_k\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N_{min}) \leq \epsilon$. Therefore, the feasible condition for **P1** is

$$\hat{G} \frac{1 - (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta))^{N_{min}}}{\mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta)} \leq \epsilon,$$

where $\hat{G} = \frac{\eta}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_{max}} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) + \frac{2L\eta^2}{K^2\chi} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_{max}} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) + \frac{4L\eta^2}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \Lambda_k^2$, which is derived based on Corollary 1. For ease of illustration, we suppose that **P1** has feasible solutions.

VI. TRAINING TIME MINIMIZATION

In this section, we adopt the alternating optimization technique to solve **P1**. We first divide **P1** into three subproblems, and then optimize $\{\delta_k\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and $\{B_k\}$ in Section VI-A, VI-B, and VI-C, respectively. Overall, we propose the bandwidth, batch size, and position optimization (BBPO) scheme, which can compute a suboptimal solution of **P1** efficiently in Section VI-D.

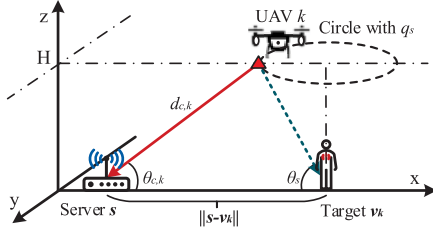


Fig. 5. An illustration of the optimal UAV position with given q_s . The optimal position is marked with a red triangle.

A. Bandwidth Allocation Optimization With Fixed Batch Size and Position

We consider the subproblem of **P1** for optimizing the bandwidth allocation $\{B_k\}$ by assuming that batch size $\{\delta_k\}$, UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and training round N are fixed. It follows from (2) that the successful sensing probability $\{q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)\}$ are given. Given that $\{\delta_k\}$ and $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ satisfy the constraints (23a), and (23c)-(23f), **P1** reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P2}: \min_{\{B_k\}} & T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} & \mathbb{E} \left[T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k) + T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k) + T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k) + T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k) \right] \\ & \leq T_{\max}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \forall n \in \mathcal{N}_\epsilon, \\ & \text{constraint (23g)}. \end{aligned} \quad (24a)$$

Since we assume **P1** has feasible solutions, constraint (23h) will definitely be satisfied. Therefore, (23h) will not be included in the subsequent problem formulations. Constraint (24a) is the same as (23b). Specifically, due to (5), constraints (24a) can be simplified to

$$\frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)} + T_0 \cdot \delta_k + q_s \cdot \frac{\delta_k \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}} + q_s \cdot \frac{D_0}{r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)} \leq T_{\max}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \quad (25)$$

where $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = q_s, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. Since the left hand side of constraints (25) are convex with respect to $\{B_k\}$, **P2** is a standard convex problem. Therefore, it can be efficiently solved by convex optimization tools such as CVX [35].

B. Batch Size Optimization With Fixed Position and Bandwidth Allocation

We consider the subproblem of **P1** for optimizing batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ by assuming that $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, $\{B_k\}$, and training round N are fixed. Since the successful sensing probability $q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = q_s, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ is determined by $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, parameter q_s is also given. In this case, given that $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ and $\{B_k\}$ satisfy the constraints (23c)-(23e), and (23g), **P1** reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P3}: \min_{\{\delta_k\}} & T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} & \delta_k > 0, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \\ & \text{constraints (23a), (25),} \end{aligned} \quad (26a)$$

where we relax the value of $\{\delta_k\}$ from integer in (23f) to real number $\delta_k > 0, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$, and (23b) is simplified as (25). In cases where no UAV successfully detects the target, we account for a maximum acceptable delay denoted

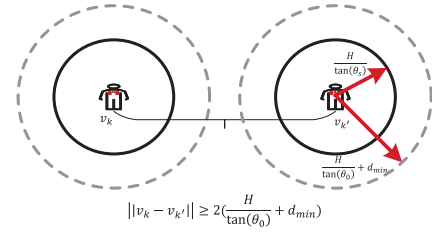


Fig. 6. An illustration of the UAVs' positions in the collision-free scenario.

as $T_{\max} \leq T_{\text{tol}}$ for each training round. Next, we characterize the optimal solution of **P3** as follows.

Lemma 1: At the optimal $\{\delta_k^*\}$ of **P3**, equality constraint in (25) holds. That is,

$$\frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)} + T_0 \delta_k^* + \frac{q_s \delta_k^* \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}} + \frac{q_s D_0}{r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)} = T_{\max}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}. \quad (27)$$

Thus, each δ_k^* can be represented as a function of $T_{\max}$, i.e.,

$$\delta_k^*(T_{\max}) = \frac{T_{\max} - \frac{D_0}{r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)} - \frac{q_s D_0}{r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)}}{T_0 + \frac{q_s \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}}}. \quad (28)$$

According to (20), as $\Phi(\{\delta_k(T_{\max})\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N)$ increases, $T_{\max}$ decreases. To minimize $T_{\max}$, we consider $\Phi(\{\delta_k(T_{\max})\}, \{\mathbf{u}_k\}, N) = \epsilon$ in (23a). Based on (20), (22) and (23a), we have

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{\eta}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k^*(T_{\max})} + \frac{2L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi q_s} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k^*(T_{\max})} + J \\ & = \frac{(1-A)(\epsilon - \lambda A^N)}{1 - A^N}, \end{aligned} \quad (29)$$

where $J = \left(\frac{\eta}{K} + \frac{4L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi q_s} + \frac{4L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi^2} \right) \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \Lambda_k^2$, $A = 1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta)$, and $\lambda = \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^0) - F(\mathbf{w}^*)]$. It can be transformed into a polynomial equation with respect to $T_{\max}$ and solved efficiently.

C. Position Optimization With Fixed Batch Size and Bandwidth Allocation

We consider the subproblem of **P1** for optimizing UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ by assuming that $\{\delta_k\}$, $\{B_k\}$, and training round N are fixed. In this case, **P1** given that $\{\delta_k\}$ and $\{B_k\}$ satisfy the constraints (23f) and (23g) reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P4}: \min_{\{\mathbf{u}_k\}} & T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} & \text{constraints (23a), (25), (23c)-(23e)}. \end{aligned}$$

Constraints (23b) in **P1** can be simplified as (25). we consider two scenarios regarding whether the UAVs consistently adhere to collision avoidance constraint (23e).

Collision-free scenario: In this scenario, we assume that the sensing targets are geometrically separated, ensuring that the UAVs will never collide with each other. As illustrated in Fig. 5, the UAVs must satisfy $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) \geq \theta_0, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ to maintain adequate sensing quality, constraining their positions to within a specific circle. The center of this circle is at the target location $\mathbf{v}_k = (x_{v,k}, y_{v,k}, z_{v,k})$ with $z_{v,k} = H$, and the radius is $\frac{H}{\tan \theta_0}$. As illustrated in Fig. 6, which presents

a top-down view of Fig. 5 in the manuscript, it is clear that if any two sensing targets satisfy the following constraint, the corresponding UAVs will never collide with each other.

$$\|v_k - v_{k'}\|^2 \geq 4 \left(\frac{H}{\tan \theta_0} + d_{\min} \right)^2, \forall k, k' \in \mathcal{K}. \quad (30)$$

Next, we solve **P1** in this collision-free scenario. We transform the constraints on $\{u_k\}$ of **P4** into constraints on q_s , as this will simplify our optimization. Since (23c) indicates $q_{s,k}(u_k) = q_s, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$, we omit the transformation of (23c).

1) *Constraint (23a)*: Based on (20), (22), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\eta}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) + \frac{2L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi q_s} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ + \frac{4L\eta^2}{K q_s^{K-2}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \Lambda_k^2 \leq \frac{(1-A)(\epsilon - \lambda A^N)}{1 - A^N}. \end{aligned} \quad (31)$$

Since $q_s \geq q_{s,\min}$, (31) can be rewritten as

$$\begin{aligned} q_s \geq \frac{2L\eta^2}{K^2 \chi} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ \left/ \left[\frac{(1-A)(\epsilon - \lambda A^N)}{1 - A^N} - \frac{\eta}{K} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) - \frac{4L\eta^2}{K q_{s,\min}^{K-2}} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \Lambda_k^2 \right] \right. \end{aligned} \quad (32)$$

2) *Constraint (23d)*: According to (2), the successful sensing probability increases as the sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(u_k)$ increases. Based on (23d), we have

$$q_s \geq \frac{1}{1 + \psi \exp(-\zeta[\theta_0 - \psi])}. \quad (33)$$

3) *Relationship Between q_s and $r_{b,k}(u_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(u_k, B_k)$ in Constraint (25)*: After the above constraint transformations, we can see that only $r_{b,k}(u_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(u_k, B_k)$ in **P4** contains u_k . According to the expression of them in (8) and (10), we have the following proposition.

Proposition 1: For any given q_s and B_k , the optimal position $u_k^* = (x_{u,k}^*, y_{u,k}^*, H)$ of each UAV k simultaneously maximizes the global model download rate $r_{b,k}(u_k, B_c)$ and the local gradient upload rate $r_k(u_k, B_k)$ is $x_{u,k}^* = x_{v,k} - \frac{H(x_{v,k} - x_s)}{\tan \theta_s \|s - v_k\|}$ and $y_{u,k}^* = y_{v,k} - \frac{H(y_{v,k} - y_s)}{\tan \theta_s \|s - v_k\|}$, where θ_s is the corresponding sensing elevation angle of q_s in (2).

Proof: From solid geometry, position u_k^* leads to the minimum UAV-server distance $d_{c,k}$, and the maximum elevation angle $\theta_{c,k}$. Since we consider the same channel model for uplink and downlink between UAVs and the server in (7), we have the maximum $r_{b,k}(u_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(u_k, B_k)$. $\square$

We mark the optimal position with a red triangle in Fig. 5.

Lemma 2: According to u_k^* given q_s in Proposition 1, the global model download rate $r_{b,k}(u_k, B_c)$ and transmission rate $r_k(u_k, B_k)$ can be written as $\hat{r}_{b,k}(q_s, B_c)$ and $\hat{r}_k(q_s, B_k)$. They are both monotonically decreasing functions of q_s .

Proof: From Fig. 5, we have the relationship between $\theta_{c,k}$ and θ_s as $\theta_{c,k} = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{H}{\|s - v_k\| - \frac{H}{\tan \theta_s}} \right) \times \frac{180^\circ}{\pi}$, which is derived by $\frac{H}{\tan \theta_{c,k}} + \frac{H}{\tan \theta_s} = \|s - v_k\|$. Moreover, the relationship between $d_{c,k}^2$ and θ_s is $d_{c,k}^2 = \left(\|s - v_k\| - \frac{H}{\tan \theta_s} \right)^2 + H^2$. Based on (2), the sensing elevation angle θ_s can be represented as

Algorithm 1 UAV Position Optimization

Input: Fixed batch size $\{\delta_k\}$; fixed bandwidth allocation $\{B_k\}$; accuracy threshold τ_q ;

- 1 Determine the lower bound for q_s using (32) and (33); Set up the search interval ϵ_q for q_s ;
- 2 **for** $q_s = \text{LowerBound}(q_s) : \epsilon_q : 1$ **do**
- 3 **repeat**
- 4 Set the iteration index as $j = 0$;
- 5 Optimize each UAV k 's position u_k by solving **P5-2**;
- 6 Record per round latency $T_{\max}(u_k^{(j)})$;
- 7 **until** $|T_{\max}(u_k^{(j)}) - T_{\max}(u_k^{(j-1)})| / T_{\max}(u_k^{(j-1)}) \leq \tau_q$;
- 8 Find the optimal UAV position

$$u_k^* = \arg \min_{q_s \in \{\text{LowerBound}(q_s), \dots, 1\}} \max_{k \in \mathcal{K}} T_{\max}(u_k^{(j)});$$

Output: $\{u_k^*\} = \{u_k^{(j)}\}$.

a function of q_s , i.e., $\theta_s = -\frac{1}{\zeta} \left[\ln \left(\frac{1}{q_s} - 1 \right) - \ln \psi \right] + \psi$. Substituting the above equations into (8), we have $\hat{r}_{b,k}(q_s, B_c)$ and $\hat{r}_k(q_s, B_k)$. Also, they decrease monotonically as q_s increases. $\square$

Based on Proposition 1 and Lemma 2, **P4** is rewritten as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P4'}: \quad & \min_{q_s} T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \frac{D_0}{\hat{r}_{b,k}(q_s, B_c)} + T_0 \delta_k + \frac{q_s \delta_k \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}} + \frac{q_s D_0}{\hat{r}_k(q_s, B_k)} \\ & \leq T_{\max}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \end{aligned} \quad (34a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & 0 < q_s \leq 1, \\ & \text{constraints (32), (33)}. \end{aligned} \quad (34b)$$

Since $\hat{r}_{b,k}(q_s, B_c)$ and $\hat{r}_k(q_s, B_k)$ are monotonically decreasing functions of q_s , we can first achieve the minimum $T_{\max}$ by minimizing q_s from (34a). We first find the minimum q_s^* that satisfies constraints (32), (33), and (34b). Then, based on (34a) we have $T_{\max} = \max_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left\{ \frac{D_0}{\hat{r}_{b,k}(q_s^*, B_c)} + T_0 \delta_k + q_s^* \frac{\delta_k \xi}{f_{\text{cpu}}} + q_s^* \frac{D_0}{\hat{r}_k(q_s^*, B_k)} \right\}$. Finally, the optimal $\{u_k^*\}$ is derived from Proposition 1.

Potential collision scenario: We still transform the constraints on $\{u_k\}$ of **P4** into constraints on q_s . After the transformations, **P4** can be written as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P5}: \quad & \min_{\{u_k\}} T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \text{constraint (25), (23e), (32), (33)}. \end{aligned}$$

Constraint (32) and (33) establish a lower bound for q_s , which limits the UAV's position relative to the sensing targets. Constraint (23e) imposes mutual positioning restrictions on the UAVs, delineating constraints regarding their positions relative to each other. This problem is highly non-convex due to the complexity of the function q_s with respect to $\{u_k\}$. To tackle this challenge, we employ an alternating optimization technique by treating successful sensing probability q_s as given and optimizing the UAV positions $\{u_k\}$ alternately.

Given that q_s satisfies (32) and (33), **P5** reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} \textbf{P5-1:} \quad & \min_{\{\mathbf{u}_k\}} \quad T_{\max} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\|^2 = f(q_s), \quad \forall k \in \mathcal{K}, \\ & \text{constraint (25), (23e),} \end{aligned} \quad (35a)$$

where $f(q_s)$ represents the distance between UAV k and its sensing target with location $\mathbf{v}_k$. Since $q_s = \frac{1}{1+\psi \exp(-\zeta[\theta_s(\mathbf{u}_k) - \psi])}$ and $\theta_s = \frac{180^\circ}{\pi} \times \arcsin \left| \frac{H}{\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\|} \right|$, the distance $\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\|^2$ can be expressed as a function of q_s denoted by $f(q_s)$. However, this problem remains highly non-trivial, since the uplink and downlink transmission rates $r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ are non-convex functions of $\mathbf{u}_k$ in constraint (25). Therefore, we propose a heuristic algorithm that optimizes the UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ alternately.

First, we derive that $r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ decrease monotonically as $\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{s}\|^2$ decreases, based on (8). Given that $\{\mathbf{u}'_{k'}, \forall k' \in \mathcal{K}, k' \neq k\}$ satisfy constraint (23e) and (35a), **P5-1** then reduces to

$$\begin{aligned} \textbf{P5-2:} \quad & \min_{\mathbf{u}_k} \quad \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{s}\|^2 \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\|^2 = f(q_s), \\ & \|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{u}'_{k'}\|^2 \geq d_{min}^2, \quad \forall k' \in \mathcal{K}. \\ & \text{constraint (35a), (23e).} \end{aligned}$$

The objective function is from constraint (25), where $r_{b,k}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_c)$ and $r_k(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ are decrease monotonically as $\|\mathbf{u}_k - \mathbf{s}\|^2$ decreases. **P5-2** is a Quadratically Constrained Quadratic Programming (QCQP) problem. To solve this, we need to convert it into its Lagrangian form and compute the gradients. Using the CVXPY tool within Matlab to determine the optimal solution.

Based on the solutions of **P5-2**, we propose the iterative algorithm for **P5**, summarized in Algorithm 1. We first employ a one-dimension search for q_s . With each given q_s , we solve sub-problems **P5-2** for $\{\mathbf{u}_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}\}$ alternately, achieving convergence within a finite number of iterations.

D. Iterative Bandwidth, Batch Size, and Position Optimization (BBPO)

Based on the solutions of the three subproblems in the above sections, we propose the iterative algorithm for **P1**, summarized in Algorithm 2.⁷ We first employ a one-dimension search for N . With each given N , we solve sub-problems **P2**, **P3**, and **P4** alternately, achieving convergence within a finite number of iterations [36]. Thus, we have the proposition as⁸

Proposition 2: ***P1** can be efficiently solved by the BBPO scheme (i.e., Algorithm 2) in polynomial time $\mathcal{O}(I(N_{max} - N_{min})((K+1)^4 + \log T_{tol}))$.*

Proof: Suppose the alternating optimization requires I iterations to converge. In each iteration, we optimize **P2-P4**

⁷The parameters A and λ are defined in (29). The minimum N_{min} is derived by (20). with constraint $\lambda(1-A) - G_{max} > 0$, where G_{max} is derived by (22) with $q_s = 1$ and $\delta_k = \delta_{max}, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. The maximum N_{max} depends on the maximum tolerance training time and is thus a given parameter.

⁸Note that we examine the time complexity and the simulation results of **P1** in the collision-free scenario in Section VI-C.

Algorithm 2 Iterative Bandwidth, Batch Size, and Position Optimization (BBPO)

Input: UAV set $\mathcal{K}$; target location set $\{\mathbf{v}_k\}$; UAV transmission power $\{p_{c,k}\}$; the minimum sensing elevation angle θ_0 ; accuracy threshold τ ; the minimum training round $N_{min} = \log_A \left(\frac{\epsilon(1-A) - G_{max}}{\lambda(1-A) - G_{max}} \right)$; the maximum training round N_{max} ;

- 1 **for** $n = N_{min} : N_{max}$ **do**
- 2 Set the iteration index of the following three steps as $i = 0$;
- 3 Initialize UAV batch size $\{\delta_k^{(i)}\}$ to satisfy the constraints in (23f) and UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k^{(i)}\}$ to satisfy the constraints in (23c) and (23d);
- 4 **repeat**
- 5 Fix $\{\delta_k^{(i)}\}$ and $\{\mathbf{u}_k^{(i)}\}$, optimize bandwidth $\{B_k^{(i)}\}$ by solving **P2** in Section VI-A;
- 6 Fix $\{\mathbf{u}_k^{(i)}\}$ and $\{B_k^{(i)}\}$, optimize batch size $\{\delta_k^{(i)}\}$ by solving **P3** in Section VI-B;
- 7 Fix $\{\delta_k^{(i)}\}$ and $\{B_k^{(i)}\}$, optimize position $\{\mathbf{u}_k^{(i)}\}$ by solving **P4** in Section VI-C;
- 8 Let $T_{max}^{(i)}(n)$ be the objective value of **P4**;
- 9 Update $i = i + 1$;
- 10 **until** $|T_{max}^{(i)}(n) - T_{max}^{(i-1)}(n)| / T_{max}^{(i-1)}(n) \leq \tau$;
- 11 Find the optimal training round $N^* = \arg \min_{n \in \{N_{min}, \dots, N_{max}\}} n \cdot T_{max}^{(i)}(n)$;

Output: $\{\delta_k^*\} = \{\lceil \delta_k^{(i)} \rceil\}$, $\{\mathbf{u}_k^*\} = \{\mathbf{u}_k^{(i)}\}$, and $\{B_k^*\} = \{B_k^{(i)}\}$.

with the following complexities: 1) **P2** is convex and solved using the CVX tool with a time complexity of $\mathcal{O}((K+1)^4)$ [35], [37]. This is because the default solver in CVX is SDPT3, and it is based on the primal-dual interior point method. 2) According to Lemma 1, **P3** reduces to a nonlinear equation, solved using Newton's method with a time complexity of $\mathcal{O}(\log T_{tol})$ [37], where T_{tol} is the maximum tolerated per round latency. 3) Solving **P4** involves finding minimum q_s (among 3 constraints), maximum T_{max} (among K values), and computing UAV positions based on q_s . Its time complexity is $\mathcal{O}(K+4)$, which can be omitted compared with the complexity of **P2**. Moreover, we adopt a one-dimension search for optimal N in $[N_{min}, N_{max}]$. As a result, the overall time complexity to solve **P1** with the BBPO scheme is $\mathcal{O}(I(N_{max} - N_{min})((K+1)^4 + \log T_{tol}))$. $\square$

VII. SIMULATION RESULTS

In this section, we present the numerical results to evaluate the performance of our proposed BBPO scheme. We first describe the basic simulation settings in Section VII-A. Then, we discuss the baseline schemes in Section VII-B. We demonstrate and compare the BBPO scheme's performance with the baseline schemes in Section VII-C.

TABLE I
SYSTEM PARAMETERS

Parameter	Value
Number of ISAC devices, K	8
Model data size, D_0	18.69 MB
Communication bandwidth, B_c	6 MHz [38]
Server transmit power, p_b	46 dBm [39]
UAV communication transmit power, p_c	20 dBm [38]
Carrier frequency, f_c	60 GHz [7]
Noise power spectral density, N_0	-174 dBm/Hz [7]
Path-loss exponent, α	2 [39]
Path-loss for LOS, NLOS, η_1, η_2	3, 23 dB [39]
Environment parameters, ψ, ζ	11.95, 0.14 [39]
Sensing bandwidth, B_s	10 MHz [7]
Sensing transmit power, p_s	30 dBm [7]
Chirp duration, T_p	10 μ s [7]
Chirp numbers per frame, M	25 [7]
Unit sensing time, T_0	0.5 s [7]
CPU frequency, f_{cpu}	5×10^8 cycles/s [7]
CPU cycles for one sample, ξ	2.5×10^7 [7]
Sampling rate, f_s	10 MHz [7]

A. Simulation Settings

1) *UAV-Assisted FEEL System*: We consider a UAV-assisted federated learning system with an edge server and $K = 8$ ISAC UAVs. The UAVs are randomly distributed within a circular area of radius 300 meters and are geometrically separated at different positions for sensing. Moreover, we define the minimum sensing elevation angle as $\theta_0 = 70^\circ$, corresponding to PSNR = 30 dB in Fig. 3. Other simulation parameters⁹ are listed in Table I.

2) *Human Motion Recognition*: We apply the wireless sensing simulator in [22] to simulate various human motions and generate datasets. In the simulation, we aim to identify five different human motions, i.e., child walking, child pacing, adult walking, adult pacing, and standing [7]. Examples of data samples of each human motion are shown in Fig. 2.

3) *Learning Model*: We apply widely used ResNet-10 (4,900,677 model parameters) with batch normalization as the classifier model. Each model parameter is stored as a 32-bit floating-point value, providing high precision. The data size is $D_0 = 18.69$ MB. The learning rate is set to $\eta = 0.03$. The pre-trained FEEL model, training data, and the source code to reproduce the results in the paper are available at <https://github.com/TheaSherlock/ISCC-UAV>.

B. Baseline Schemes

- **Baseline 1:** (Det-UAVposition) This scheme considers that the UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ is given. The batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ and bandwidth $\{B_k\}$ are optimized as discussed in Section VI-A and Section VI-B in our proposed scheme. By comparing with this baseline, we evaluate the validity of the UAV position design in our proposed scheme.
- **Baseline 2:** (Eq-Bandwidth) This scheme uses the uniform bandwidth $B_k = B_c/K$ for uplink transmission in Section VI-A. The batch size $\{\delta_k\}$ and UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ are optimized as discussed in Section VI-B and Section VI-C in our proposed scheme. By comparing

⁹The formulation and analysis can be readily adapted to accommodate wide bandwidth or low center frequency scenarios as well.

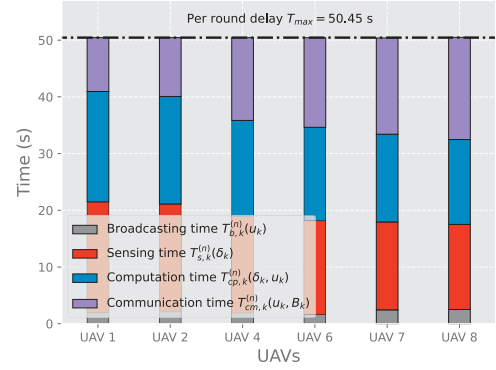


Fig. 7. An illustration of broadcasting time $T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)$, sensing time $T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k)$, computation time $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$, and communication time $T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ of participating UAVs in round $n = 441$ under our proposed BBPO scheme. UAV 3 and UAV 5 do not participate in this training round, since they do not sense the targets successfully.

with this baseline, we evaluate the validity of bandwidth allocation in our proposed scheme.

- **Baseline 3:** (Eq-Batchsize) This scheme considers the uniform batch size $\delta_k = \delta, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ in Section VI-B. The bandwidth $\{B_k\}$ and UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ are optimized as discussed in Section VI-A and Section VI-C in our proposed scheme. By comparing with this baseline, we evaluate the validity of batch size design in our proposed scheme.
- **Baseline 4:** (BBPO-Ideal) The only difference between Baseline 4 and the proposed BBPO scheme is that this scheme assumes that all UAVs always successfully sense the targets and that all UAVs participated in each training round. Specifically, we have the successful sensing probability $q_s = 1$ in (23a), (23b), and (23f). The optimization of batch size $\{\delta_k\}$, UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$, and bandwidth $\{B_k\}$ is the same as our proposed scheme. This baseline is an ideal situation for sensing.

C. Performance Evaluation

1) *Balance effect of decision variables on $T_{\max}$* : In Fig. 7, we plot the per round delay, which is the sum of the broadcasting, sensing, computation, and communication time, of each participating UAV under the BBPO scheme. We can observe that the broadcasting time $T_{b,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ is notably shorter compared to other times. Moreover, the UAVs with longer sensing time $T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k)$ will also have longer computation time $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$. This is because $T_{s,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k)$ and $T_{cp,k}^{(n)}(\delta_k, \mathbf{u}_k)$ are proportional to batch size δ_k . Also, each UAV k can control the uplink transmission time $T_{cm,k}^{(n)}(\mathbf{u}_k, B_k)$ by adjusting its B_k , to minimize $T_{\max}$. This observation confirms our discussion in Remark 5 (illustrated in Fig. 7) that all participating UAVs achieve the same $T_{\max} = 50.45$ s.

2) *Impact of UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$ on training performance*: In Fig. 8 and Fig. 9, we evaluate the training performance of the proposed BBPO scheme by comparing with Baseline 1 (Det-UAVposition) under different UAV positions. We use sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ to reflect different UAV positions in Baseline 1. For instance, Baseline 1 ($\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = 35^\circ$) represents that current UAV position $\{\mathbf{u}_k\}$

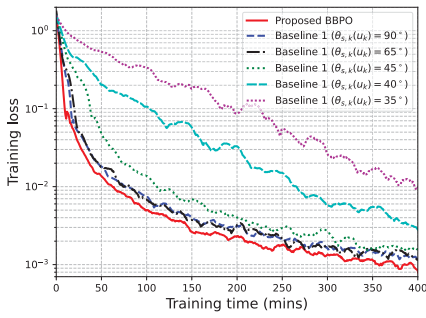


Fig. 8. Training loss versus training time under the BBPO scheme and Baseline 1.

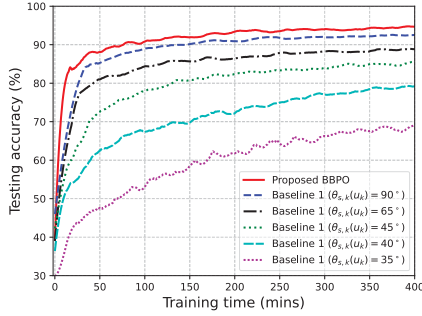


Fig. 9. Testing accuracy versus training time under the BBPO scheme and Baseline 1.

corresponds to sensing elevation angle $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = 35^\circ$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$.

In Fig. 8, we plot the training loss versus the total training time. Note that training time includes broadcasting, sensing, computation, and communication time. We can observe that the training loss decreases with training time under the BBPO scheme and Baseline 1, consistent with the analysis in Section V-B. It also shows that the BBPO scheme achieves the fastest convergence rate compared to other schemes, and the convergence rate of Baseline 1 ($\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) = 35^\circ$) is the slowest. This is because the smaller $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ indicates the further distance between the UAV and the sensing target, resulting in poor quality (i.e., lower PSNR) of data samples. It also indicates the smaller successful sensing probability $q_s(\mathbf{u}_k)$, resulting in fewer UAVs participating in training. According to (20), we need more training rounds N to achieve the specified optimality gap. However, this does not mean that a larger $\theta_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)$ will lead to a better performance. As UAVs move closer to the target but farther away from the server, the uplink transmission time and per round latency $T_{\max}$ will increase. Since we consider the trade-off between N and $T_{\max}$ in our BBPO scheme. It achieves a faster convergence rate than other baseline schemes. In Fig. 9, we plot the testing accuracy against the total training time. We observe that the BBPO scheme achieves the highest testing accuracy compared to other baseline schemes. The reason is the same as above.

3) Impact of bandwidth $\{B_k\}$ and sensing time $\{\delta_k\}$ on training performance: Fig. 10 and Fig. 11 show the training performance under four schemes. Compared with Baseline 2 (Eq-Bandwidth) and Baseline 3 (Eq-Batchsize), the proposed BBPO scheme achieves the best convergence rate and testing accuracy performance. Due to (23b), we try to adaptively assign different bandwidths to each UAV to minimize $T_{\max}$ under the BBPO scheme. However, in Baseline 2, all UAVs

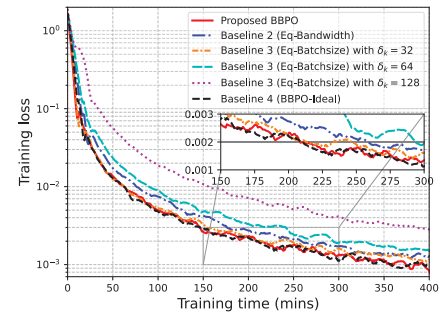


Fig. 10. Training loss versus training time under different baseline schemes.

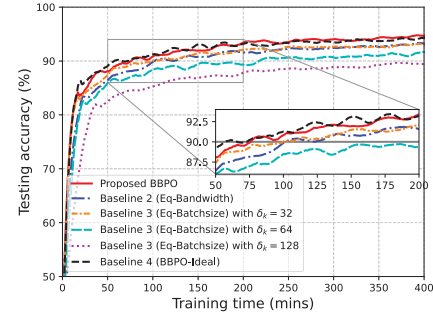


Fig. 11. Testing accuracy versus training time under different baseline schemes.

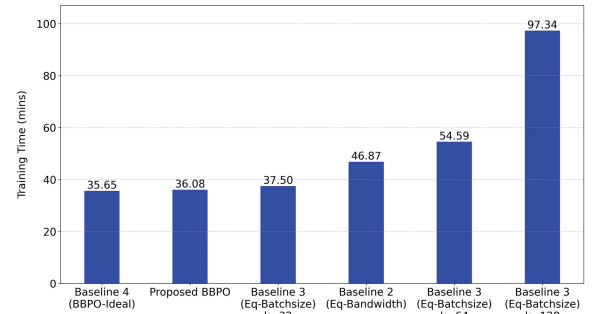


Fig. 12. An illustration of training time under different baseline schemes with an optimality gap of $\epsilon = 0.02$.

use a uniform bandwidth, which increases $T_{\max}$ and worsens the training performance. In Baseline 3, we consider that the UAVs have the uniform batch size $\delta_k = 32$, $\delta_k = 64$, and $\delta_k = 128$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. While an increased value of δ_k reduces N , it simultaneously raises $T_{\max}$, leading to a slower convergence rate. However, it's important to note that a smaller δ_k does not necessarily imply better performance. This is because a smaller δ_k decreases $T_{\max}$ but increases N . Therefore, the BBPO scheme that jointly optimizes $\{\delta_k\}$ and $\{B_k\}$ outperforms Baseline 2 and Baseline 3 in both Fig. 10 and Fig. 11. Specifically, in Fig. 10 under the same training loss $\epsilon = 0.002$, the training time of the BBPO scheme is 19.23% less than Baseline 2, 4.55% less than Baseline 3 with $\delta_k = 32$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$, and 27.59% less than Baseline 3 with $\delta_k = 64$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. In Fig. 11, to achieve a testing accuracy of 90%, the training time of the BBPO scheme is 28.57% less than Baseline 2 and Baseline 3 with $\delta_k = 32$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. It is 58.33% less than Baseline 3 with $\delta_k = 64$, $\forall k \in \mathcal{K}$. Moreover, it achieves almost the same performance as the ideal case Baseline 4.

4) The comparison of training time: In Fig. 12, we compare the training time under different baseline schemes. We set the optimality gap $\epsilon = 0.02$ in **P1**, derive the suboptimal

solution for training, and then calculate the total training time for each scheme. The proposed BBPO scheme requires the least training time to achieve the same optimality gap compared to Baseline 2 (Eq-Bandwidth) and Baseline 3 (Eq-Batchsize). Furthermore, the BBPO scheme's training time is almost equivalent to that of the ideal case Baseline 4.

VIII. CONCLUSION

In this paper, we investigated the UAV deployment design and resource allocation in UAV-assisted federated edge learning (FEEL) for improving training performance. Specifically, we studied the impact of UAV deployment on sensing quality for human motion recognition. We identified a threshold for the sensing elevation angle that produces satisfactory quality of data samples. Then, we derived an upper bound on the UAV-assisted FEEL training loss as a function of the successful sensing probability, and showed that the negative impact of data heterogeneity can be reduced if UAVs have a uniform successful sensing probability. Based on the convergence analysis, we minimized the total training time by jointly optimizing the UAV deployment and integrated sensing, computation, and communication (ISCC) resources. Then, we applied the alternating optimization technique and decomposed this challenging mixed-integer non-convex problem into three subproblems. Moreover, we proposed the BBPO scheme to alternately optimize bandwidth, batch size, and position, which efficiently computes suboptimal solutions. Simulation results showed that our BBPO scheme outperforms other baselines in terms of convergence rate and testing accuracy.

APPENDIX PROOF OF THEOREM 1

Based on Assumption 1, the expected loss function $F(\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)})$ can be expressed as

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)})] \\ & \leq \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})] + \mathbb{E}[\langle \nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}), \mathbf{w}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{w}^{(n)} \rangle] \\ & \quad + \frac{L}{2} \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{w}^{(n)}\|^2]. \end{aligned} \quad (36)$$

We provide two key lemmas before deriving the convergence rate.

Lemma 3: With Assumption 3 and Assumption 4, it holds that

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[\langle \nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}), \mathbf{w}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{w}^{(n)} \rangle] \\ & \leq -\frac{\eta}{2} \mathbb{E}[\|\nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2] + \eta \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \alpha_k^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right), \end{aligned} \quad (37)$$

where each $\alpha_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ is a function of $\{q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)\}$. Detailed expression of $\{\alpha_k\}$ is in [34].

Lemma 4: With Assumption 3 and Assumption 4, it holds that

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{w}^{(n)}\|^2] \\ & \leq 2\eta^2 \left(\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \Lambda_k^2 \right. \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \left. + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ & + 4\eta^2 \mathbb{E}[\|\nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2], \end{aligned} \quad (38)$$

where each $\beta_k, \gamma_k, \forall k \in \mathcal{K}$ is a function of $\{q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k)\}$. Detailed expressions of $\{\beta_k\}, \{\gamma_k\}$ are in [34].

By substituting (37) and (38) into (36), we have

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)})] \\ & \leq \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})] - \left(\frac{\eta}{2} - 2L\eta^2 \right) \mathbb{E}[\|\nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2] + \eta \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \alpha_k^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ & \quad + L\eta^2 \left(\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \Lambda_k^2 + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ & \leq \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})] - \mu\eta(1-4L\eta) \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] + \eta \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \alpha_k^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) \\ & \quad + L\eta^2 \left(\sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \Lambda_k^2 + 2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2 \right), \end{aligned} \quad (39)$$

where (39) is due to $\|\nabla F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)})\|^2 \geq 2\mu(F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*))$ based on Assumption 2. Subtracting $\mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}_*)]$ in both sides of (39), we have

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n+1)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] \\ & \leq (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta)) \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] + G, \end{aligned} \quad (40)$$

where $G = \eta \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \alpha_k^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + \Lambda_k^2 \right) + L\eta^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \beta_k \left(\frac{\sigma_k^2}{\delta_k} + 2\Lambda_k^2 \right) + 2L\eta^2 \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}} \gamma_k \left((q_{s,k}(\mathbf{u}_k) - \bar{q}_s)^2 + \bar{q}_s^2 \right) \Lambda_k^2$. Applying (40) recursively, we have

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^{(n)}) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)] \\ & \leq G \frac{1 - (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta))^n}{\mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta)} + (1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta))^n \lambda, \end{aligned} \quad (41)$$

where $\lambda = \mathbb{E}[F(\mathbf{w}^0) - F(\mathbf{w}_*)]$. To guarantee the convergence of the training, we have $1 - \mu\eta(1 - 4L\eta) < 1$, which leads to $0 < \eta < \frac{1}{4L}$. Thus, Theorem 1 is proved. The proof of Lemmas 3 and 4 are given in [34].

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